Katherine Tosi

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Senior Education Leader and Institutional Builder · Curriculum Design · Student Services, Inclusion and Belonging · AI Literacy and Academic Integrity · EAP / English-Medium Instruction · IB, IGCSE, A-Level, Liberal Arts

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior education leader and institutional builder with **34 years across 6 countries** (United States, Switzerland, Thailand, Australia, Myanmar, and China). I build what isn't there yet, then leave it running: an EAL department and a professional development system for 113 teachers at Dulwich College Beijing, whole-school student services from inception in 12 months at Harrow Shanghai, and four original first-year courses plus the strategic vision for a **Center for Academic Inquiry** at NYU Shanghai. Integrated leadership across curriculum, belonging, community impact, and institutional strategy, with measurable results (12% senior school attainment gain in one year). Deep experience with the IB Diploma Programme, IGCSE, A-Level, English National Curriculum, and undergraduate liberal arts (Middle States accreditation). Completing the National Professional Qualification for Headship at UCL Institute of Education (expected May 2027). Available from July 2027.

"The most important aspect of my work is whom I teach, not what I teach."

SELECTED IMPACT

- **Built from zero, three times:** an EAL department and a Rolling Professional Development program for **113 teachers** (Dulwich College Beijing); whole-school student services, Nursery to Year 13, in **12 months** (Harrow Shanghai); and **four original first-year courses** with all-original materials (NYU Shanghai).
- **Raised attainment: 12% gain** in senior school student attainment in one year through targeted academic intervention (Dulwich).
- **Led people:** line-managed a **team of 16** (teachers, in-class support teachers, teaching assistants) and trained whole staffs, Nursery to Year 13, in inclusive practice, CLIL, and differentiation.
- **Shaped strategy:** co-authored the 48-page EAP Academic Program Review Self-Study and the department's **strategic vision and five-year plan**, proposing a **Center for Academic Inquiry** with mandatory AI literacy for all first-years.
- **Taught at scale, rated highly: 500+ first-year students from 70+ countries** since 2018; Spring 2025 evaluations of **4.78/5** overall instructor rating and **4.91/5** for integrating diverse perspectives.
- **Connected classrooms to community:** assessed service partnerships with Shanghai non-profits, including a student SDG campaign that led to a **permanent vegan/halal cafeteria stall**; Campus Point of Contact for the **UN Millennium Fellowship**.

EDUCATION

National Professional Qualification for Headship (NPQH), in progress
UCL Institute of Education · Expected May 2027
Implementation project: AI and Academic Integrity

Postgraduate Certificate in Inclusion and Special Needs (SENCO)
University of Wolverhampton, UK · Jan 2014 – Jul 2015
National Award for Special Educational Needs Coordinator

Diploma in Special Educational Needs
The Blackford Centre, Somerset, UK · 2014

MA, TESOL / Applied Linguistics (with distinction)
University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia · 2002 – 2004

BA, Literary and Cultural Studies; Creative Writing and Composition · Minor: German
University of Vermont, USA · 1987 – 1992

LICENSURE AND STATUTORY CREDENTIALS

- **School Leadership Licensure Assessment (SLLA 6990)**, Educational Testing Service · Score: 164 (passed) · Aug 2025
- **Vermont English Language Arts Teaching License, Grades 7–12** · Valid through Jun 2029 · Highly Qualified Teacher Status
- **Designated Safeguarding Lead Training**, Caredemy, UK · 2025–2027
- **AI and Online Safety for Designated Safeguarding Leads**, National Compliance Training · Oct 2026

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

New York University Shanghai

Shanghai, China

Senior Lecturer · Community Connections Faculty Chair (Office of Community Inclusion) · Center for Student Belonging Facilitator · UN Millennium Fellowship Campus Point of Contact

February 2017 – Present · Adjunct, School of Professional Studies (Spring 2017) · Lecturer (Aug 2018 – 2025) · Senior Lecturer (2025 – Present)

China's first Sino-US research university and third degree-granting campus of the NYU Global Network. Nearly 2,000 students from 70+ countries. English-medium liberal arts curriculum. Middle States accredited.

- **Adjunct, School of Professional Studies** (Programs in Professional English), Feb – May 2017, alongside the Harrow role: taught the public speaking course ***Listen Up and Speak Out!*** to adult professionals.
- Designed and launched **4 new courses** from concept to full delivery: Future Focused: The Future of Work (EAP 100), (Un)Sustainability (EAP 100), Systems Thinking (EAP 101), and The History of Rock and Roll. Awarded a competitive **Experiential Learning Curriculum Design Fellowship** (Center for Teaching and Learning, Fall 2023).
- **EAP 101: Systems Thinking**: a seminar course on how students grow as learners and thinkers and how the world around them works, built on the Waters Center's Habits of a Systems Thinker, the Iceberg Model, causal loop diagrams, and system archetypes. Students lead midterm and final seminars and produce a multimedia video project from a research interview they plan and conduct themselves.
- Taught **500+ first-year students from 70+ countries** since 2018. Built complete assessment architecture, learning outcomes, experiential components, and community partnerships for each course, with all original materials (no textbook).
- Built the **DIEP reflective framework** (Describe, Interpret, Evaluate, Plan) into every course; designed experiential learning through community service, SDG campaigns, climate simulation, and **student-designed democratic voting systems**.
- Co-developed the **7 Continuums of Learner Agency** framework with Kathleen McClaskey (Voice, Choice, Engagement, Motivation, Ownership, Purpose, Self-Efficacy).
- **Chair, faculty Community Connections initiatives**, Office of Community Inclusion: equity strategy, curriculum review, faculty engagement, and community-building.
- **Workshop Facilitator, Center for Student Belonging** (2023, Summer 2025, Fall 2025). **Co-Facilitator, LEAD mentorship** for first-generation and underrepresented students (8 mentees).
- Coordinated ***Black Girl from Pyongyang*** with memoirist Monica Macías and the Writing Program (September 2026, 65 attendees).
- **Campus Point of Contact and Advisor, UN Millennium Fellowship** (involved since the 2023 launch at NYU Shanghai; appointed Campus Point of Contact in 2026). Liaison to the global program (15,000+ fellows, 330+ campuses, 48 countries), mentoring students from coursework into funded social-impact projects.
- **Co-authored the 48-page EAP Academic Program Review Self-Study** (March 2026) with the Area Head, the Assistant Dean for Academic Affairs, and a faculty colleague. Co-wrote the **strategic vision and five-year plan**, proposing the **Center for Academic Inquiry (CAI)**: a required first-year experience integrating AI literacy, digital literacy, ethical reasoning, and experiential learning. Benchmarked against Duke Kunshan, XJTLU, and UNNC, and led revised student learning outcomes for the 4-to-3 credit rightsizing initiative.
- Integrated **AI literacy and digital skills** into the curriculum; led faculty engagement on responsible AI use in teaching and assessment.
- **Organizer, annual EAP Poster Show** (2018–2025): the only whole-department public event, eight consecutive years; university-wide exhibition with structured peer engagement; adapted online during COVID.
- Built a **community-engaged experiential learning model** embedding 4–5 hours of assessed service with Shanghai non-profits (Stepping Stones Shanghai, Good-hope Bakery of Special Youth, Shanggang Elder Nursing Home, ZROU). A student SDG campaign led to a permanent vegan/halal cafeteria stall.

- Co-founded the **NYU Shanghai Sustainability Committee** (14+ campus initiatives). Chair, inaugural **Culture and Heritage Exposition**. Advisor, **Collective Voice Student Debate** (2019–2021, 2024) and **Green Shanghai** (2018–2020). Director and Performer, faculty-student *The Great Gatsby* (2024).

Harrow International School Shanghai

Shanghai, China

Director of Student Services, Nursery through Year 13

August 2016 – August 2018

British international school, part of the Harrow International Schools network. Approximately 1,200 students aged 18 months to 18 years.

- Recruited to create the school's first comprehensive student support and academic intervention framework across all divisions. **Designed and implemented the full system within 12 months**: assessment pathways, referral structures, Individualized Education Plans, admissions screening, faculty training, intervention monitoring, and safeguarding procedures.
- Conducted **300+ student assessments annually**; used baseline data to monitor progress across all year groups.
- **Trained Nursery–Year 13 faculty** in inclusive practice, differentiation, and CLIL methodology.
- Transformed admissions and placement through **data-informed assessment**; key member of the **school leadership team**; ensured compliance with Chinese government requirements and accreditation standards.
- Initiated the **Stepping Stones Shanghai** partnership (2016); organized debate tournaments and adjudicated public forum and world schools formats.

Dulwich College Beijing

Beijing, China

Professional Development Coordinator · Head of EAL / Student Support · IB English B Teacher

August 2011 – July 2016

High-performing British international school. British International School of the Year 2011. IB Diploma averages of 37–38.

- **Built the EAL department from scratch**, replacing ad hoc pull-out support with a designed structure, assessment framework, staffing model, and curriculum; grew and managed a **team of 16** (8 teaching assistants, 4 EAL teachers, 4 in-class support teachers).
- Built the school's **professional development infrastructure from scratch**, including **Rolling PD**: all **113 teachers** designed and delivered one in-house workshop a year and attended at least three others, a prerequisite for external PD funding; tracked through the BlueSky PD system. Created English for Parents, English for Teaching Assistants, and the Language Enrichment Group.
- Achieved a **12% increase in senior school student attainment** within one year through targeted academic intervention.
- Conducted **300+ admissions assessments annually** and built the standardized assessment framework (CAT4, NGRT, writing tasks, listening exams, structured interviews), interpreting results across GL, Cambridge, English National Curriculum, IB, and IELTS scales.
- Taught IB English B, IGCSE EAL, Key Stage 3 English and EAL, SEN support, and PSHE; supervised Extended Essays and CAS; served on the Curriculum Committee.
- Led the **Language Perfect** team to **3rd place globally**, with a student ranked 1st individually (2014). Taught and organized the school's **World's Largest Lesson** launching the UN Sustainable Development Goals (2015). Debate Fellow, Beihang World Debate Academy (2015).

Bromsgrove International School

Bangkok, Thailand

Head of EAL · Head of House, Years 7–13 · Head of PSHE

January 2007 – June 2011

- Led **combined academic and pastoral programming** across the secondary school in an international boarding context; designed inclusive curriculum and in-class support for multilingual learners.
- Taught IGCSE EAL, IGCSE Literature, English, and IELTS. Launched debate programs and United Nations days in house activities.
- Contributed to **Council of International Schools (CIS) accreditation** committees (English, PSHE).

Earlier Experience

- **K–12 English Teacher and Teacher Trainer**, ILBC, Mandalay, Myanmar · 2004 – 2006. Built a **60-hour teacher training program with the British Council**.
- **IELTS Instructor**, Taylor College, Sydney · 2003 (alongside MA TESOL, UNSW).

- **Columnist**, *Kat's Window on Thailand*, The Bangkok Post · 2000 – 2003. **Curriculum Developer and Volunteer Literacy Teacher**, Mon Culture and Literature Survival Project: built a 36-unit bilingual curriculum and Mon-script fonts for a stateless refugee community.
- **Cambridge English and IELTS Instructor**, The School for New Languages, Aarau, Switzerland · 1997 – 1999.
- **German Teacher, Grades 7–12**, Springfield High School, Vermont · 1992 – 1996. Also taught English from scratch to newly arrived children: the start of a career building systems for the students schools tend to lose.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT DELIVERED

- **Workshop Leader, *Teaching Multilingual Students in an AI World***, NYU Shanghai · Nov – Dec 2026 (upcoming). Three-session faculty series on academic language, CLIL scaffolding, and assessment redesign for AI.
- **Faculty Development, Responsible AI in Teaching and Assessment**, NYU Shanghai.
- **Teacher Trainer**, Merchiston International School, Shenzhen · 2018. Week-long residency of whole-staff EAL workshops, classroom visits, and coaching.
- **INSET Day Presenter**, Harrow International School Shanghai · April 2017.
- **Graduate Writing Tutor**, NYU Silver School of Social Work, Shanghai · 2018.
- **Presenter**, ACAMIS ELL Conference (2014) · JALT Summer Symposium, Okinawa (2019) · NYU Shanghai CTL non-conference on role-playing pedagogy.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL LEARNING

Generative AI in Education, University of Glasgow (2026) · Recognizing Grooming in Schools (2026) · Diversity in Dialogue Facilitator Training, NYU Shanghai (2025, 20 hrs) · Certified Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Leader, Brandon Hall Group (2023, 40 hrs) · Flying Solo: Fostering Learner Autonomy, XJTLU (2023) · Peer Coaching and Evaluation, University of North Dakota (2022, 15 hrs) · Safeguarding Children Lead: Designated Officer Certification (2022) · Mainstreaming Education for the SDGs in Higher Education, SDSN (2022) · The Age of Sustainable Development, SDG Academy (2019) · Certified Distance Education Instructor, IDEC (2018) · Project Management Professional Training, PMI (2017, 35 hrs) · International World Schools Debate Academy, Slovenia (2016, 100 hrs) · Licensed Tutor: Teaching ESL Students in Mainstream Classes (2015); Compass Education Sustainability Practitioners

PUBLICATIONS

- **Co-author**, *The 7 Continuums of Learner Agency* (with Kathleen McClaskey)
- **Contributing author**, *To Asia With Love: A Connoisseurs' Guide to Cambodia, Laos, Thailand, and Vietnam* (ThingsAsian Press). Honorable Mention, Travel Books, 2005 Independent Book Publishing Awards.
- **Weekly columnist**, *Kat's Window on Thailand*, The Bangkok Post (2000–2003)

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

- **Founder, The Kitty Committee**, Shanghai (Dec 2023 – present): student-led, self-funded animal welfare initiative; 293 members.
- **Community-Engaged Learning Partnerships** (2016 – 2025): initiated Stepping Stones Shanghai at Harrow and sustained it through NYU Shanghai alongside Good-hope Bakery and Shanggang Elder Nursing Home.

MEMBERSHIPS AND LANGUAGES

TESOL International Association · British Association for Applied Linguistics · International AI in Education Society · Digital Education Council · Associate Member, Millennium Campus Network Civic Learning Council

English: native · **German:** professional fluency (university minor; taught German, Grades 7–12; two years in German-speaking Switzerland)

References available on request.